

Emergent Vacuum Response Theory: A Testable Framework for Nonequilibrium Electromagnetic Systems and Resonant Cavities

Erick S. Sangalang
ORCID: 0009-0009-4039-2815

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Abstract

Emergent Vacuum Response Theory (EVRT) is presented as a unified phenomenological framework for investigating whether structured, nonequilibrium electromagnetic systems may exhibit measurable stress-energy redistribution effects under asymmetric boundary conditions. The framework does not claim confirmed anomalous forces or violations of conservation laws. Instead, EVRT is organized as a falsifiable research program integrating theoretical motivation, constraint analysis, numerical simulation, cross-validated predictions, precision experimental protocols, and baseline measurement characterization. This synthesis paper summarizes the current status of the program, defines its credibility threshold, identifies key limitations, and provides a roadmap toward stronger experimental constraints. Previous experimental claims involving asymmetric electromagnetic systems, including reported thrust-like effects in resonant cavities, have generated significant interest but remain controversial due to challenges related to reproducibility, thermal drift, electromagnetic coupling, and measurement artifacts.

The EVRT program differs from such claims by explicitly emphasizing falsifiability, systematic control testing, and quantitative scaling behavior rather than isolated observations. The goal is not to assert anomalous forces, but to define experimental conditions under which structured electromagnetic stress redistribution effects can be reliably detected or constrained.

1 Introduction

The behavior of electromagnetic fields in confined, resonant, and geometrically asymmetric systems can involve nontrivial field-energy distributions and internal stress gradients. Standard electrodynamics provides the governing foundation, but complex boundary conditions and nonequilibrium excitation can motivate useful phenomenological descriptions for organizing precision tests.

Emergent Vacuum Response Theory (EVRT) is proposed as such a description. Its purpose is not to replace Maxwellian electrodynamics, quantum electrodynamics, or general relativity. Rather, EVRT asks whether structured electromagnetic systems can be used as testbeds for measurable stress-asymmetry effects that are falsifiable through controlled experiments.

This paper serves as a unified entry point for the broader EVRT research program.

2 Research Pipeline

Figure 1 summarizes the overall research pipeline. The program begins with conceptual and phenomenological modeling, proceeds through constraints and numerical predictions, and culminates in experimental protocols and baseline measurement work.

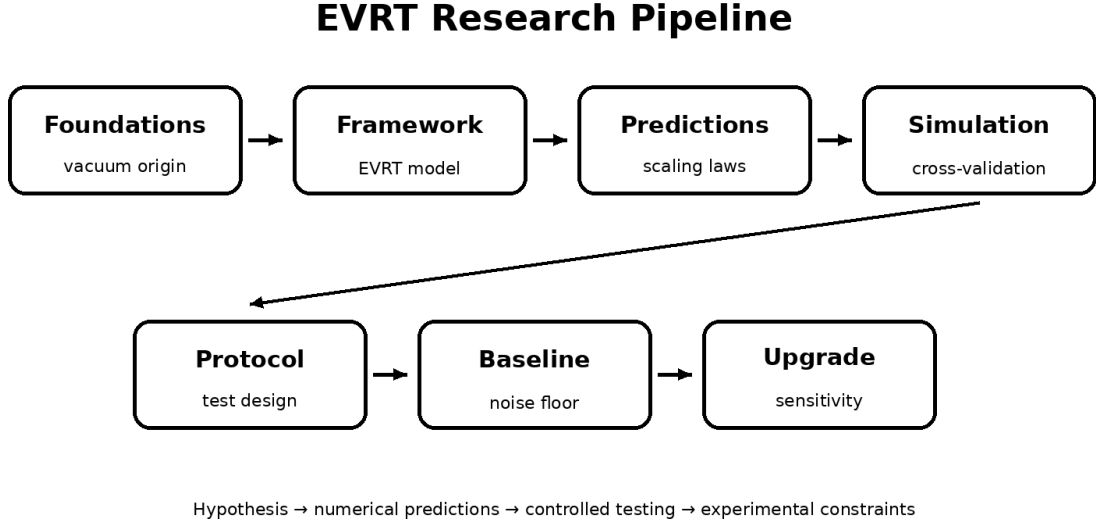


Figure 1: Two-stage representation of the EVRT research pipeline, progressing from foundational modeling to experimental validation and sensitivity refinement.

3 Core Phenomenological Framework

The electromagnetic energy density is written as

$$u = \frac{1}{2}\epsilon_0 E^2 + \frac{1}{2\mu_0} B^2. \quad (1)$$

A dimensionless asymmetry parameter is introduced:

$$A = \frac{\int (u_+ - u_-) dV}{\int (u_+ + u_-) dV}. \quad (2)$$

A representative phenomenological force-scaling relation is:

$$F \propto \chi_{\text{eff}} A (E^2 + B^2). \quad (3)$$

The proportionality constant χ_{eff} is not universal and is expected to depend on cavity geometry, mode structure, material properties, and boundary conditions. The expression should therefore be interpreted as a phenomenological scaling relation rather than a complete predictive model.

This relation is not presented as a microscopic derivation. It functions as a compact organizing law for generating falsifiable predictions.

4 Summary of Research Series

Table 1 summarizes the current research sequence and the role of each work within the overall EVRT program.

Table 1: Summary of the EVRT research series.

No.	Title	DOI	Role
1	The Entropic Vacuum	10.5281/zenodo.19797710	Foundational concept
2	Phenomenological Vacuum Electrodynamics	10.5281/zenodo.19801308	Phenomenological model
3	Microscopic and Statistical Origin of an Emergent Vacuum Pseudoscalar Mode	10.5281/zenodo.19801918	Statistical origin
4	Electro Inertial Gravity Coupling Hypothesis for Propulsion	10.5281/zenodo.19824628	Early coupling hypothesis
5	Phenomenological Considerations of Electro-Gravitational Coupling in Asymmetric Field Systems	10.5281/zenodo.19831157	Asymmetric-field coupling
6	Simulation-Guided Investigation of Emergent Vacuum Response in Resonant Electromagnetic Systems	10.5281/zenodo.19835426	Initial simulation guidance
7	Emergent Nonequilibrium Vacuum Response Theory	10.5281/zenodo.19836665	Nonequilibrium framework
8	Constraint Analysis and Parameter Bounds on Emergent Vacuum Response Models	10.5281/zenodo.19866283	Parameter constraints
9	Nonlinear and Nonequilibrium Dynamics of Emergent Vacuum Susceptibility	10.5281/zenodo.19866826	Nonlinear dynamics
10	Momentum Conservation and Effective Stress Energy Transfer in Emergent Vacuum Electrodynamics	10.5281/zenodo.19867621	Conservation analysis
11	Finite-Element Analysis of Resonant Electromagnetic Stress Redistribution in Asymmetric Cavities	10.5281/zenodo.19867999	FEM analysis
12	Precision Experimental Protocols for Testing Resonant Electromagnetic Stress Redistribution	10.5281/zenodo.19868582	Protocol design
13	EVRT: Constraints, Numerical Simulations, and Experimental Pathways	10.5281/zenodo.19891259	Program anchor
14	Possible Extensions to Effective Free-Energy Descriptions	10.5281/zenodo.19895262	Free-energy extension
15	Precision Experimental Protocols for Coherent Nonequilibrium Electromagnetic Systems	10.5281/zenodo.19896123	Coherent-system protocol
16	Minimal-Cost Experimental Test of EVRT Signatures in a Tabletop Resonator	10.5281/zenodo.19926975	Low-cost test
17	Predicted Signal Magnitudes for Tabletop Tests of EVRT	10.5281/zenodo.19927694	Signal magnitudes
18	Toward Testable Signatures of Emergent Vacuum Response	10.5281/zenodo.19931545	Quantitative predictions
19	Simulation-Based Evaluation of Field Asymmetry and Stress Imbalance	10.5281/zenodo.19932912	Simulation evaluation
20	Precision Experimental Protocol for Detecting Electromagnetic Stress Asymmetry	10.5281/zenodo.19933717	Detection protocol
21	Preliminary Experimental Setup and Baseline Characterization	10.5281/zenodo.19934142	Baseline experiment
22	Cross-Validated Numerical Predictions of Electromagnetic Stress Asymmetry	10.5281/zenodo.19951346	Cross-validated simulation

5 Quantitative Scaling Program

The EVRT predictive program emphasizes scaling behavior rather than isolated force readings. Figure 2 illustrates a representative scaling map under simplified assumptions for illustrative purposes, in which predicted force increases with both input power and asymmetry parameter.

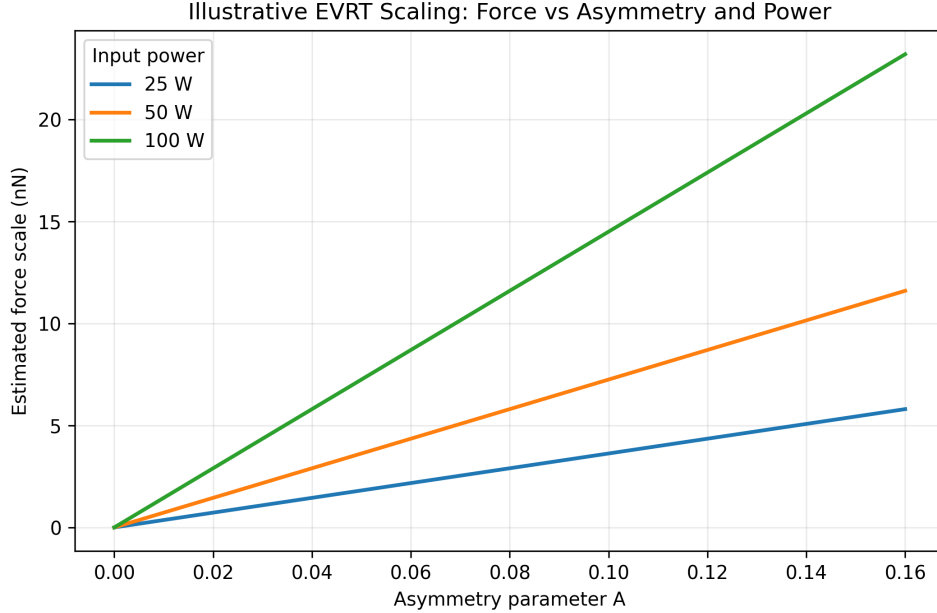


Figure 2: Illustrative EVRT scaling behavior showing estimated force scale as a function of asymmetry parameter A and input power. The plot is intended as a phenomenological guide, not a calibrated experimental result.

For representative tabletop resonator systems with input power in the range of 10–100 W and asymmetry parameters $A \sim 0.05$ – 0.15 , the present phenomenological model suggests force scales on the order of ~ 1 – 20 nN. These estimates are illustrative and depend strongly on geometry, resonance quality factor, and effective coupling assumptions.

A credible experimental signal should not merely exceed the noise floor. It should exhibit a reproducible pattern: power scaling, resonance dependence, asymmetry dependence, control suppression, and orientation reversal.

6 Experimental Test Matrix

Figure 3 summarizes the primary experimental discriminants. The goal is to distinguish a structured, model-consistent signal from drift, thermal effects, vibration, electromagnetic coupling, electrostatic artifacts, or random noise.

7 Current Status

The current status of EVRT is best summarized as follows:

- The theoretical framework remains phenomenological.

EVRT Experimental Test Matrix

Test	EVRT-like	Artifact / Noise
Power sweep	Scales with power	No stable scaling
Detuning	Drops off resonance	Weak dependence
Symmetry test	Signal suppressed	Signal persists
Orientation	Sign reversal	No reversal
Power off	No signal	Drift / noise
Repeat trials	Reproducible	Inconsistent

Figure 3: Experimental test matrix showing expected outcomes under EVRT-like scaling compared with artifact or noise behavior.

- Numerical simulations provide structured, falsifiable scaling predictions.
- Experimental protocols have been defined.
- Preliminary baseline characterization has begun.
- No confirmed anomalous force or new interaction has been experimentally established.

This distinction is essential. EVRT is not currently a confirmed theory. It is a structured research program with testable predictions.

8 Credibility Threshold

For EVRT to become scientifically compelling, future experiments must show:

- statistically significant force above the measured noise floor;
- repeatability across multiple runs;
- scaling with input power;
- enhancement near resonance;
- suppression in symmetric controls;
- sign reversal under cavity orientation reversal;
- consistency across independent apparatuses.

A single unexplained reading is not sufficient. The required evidence is a reproducible, control-dependent pattern.

9 Falsifiability

EVRT can be constrained or falsified if sufficiently sensitive experiments fail to observe the predicted scaling behavior. In particular, null results at nanonewton or sub-nanonewton sensitivity under high-asymmetry resonant conditions would strongly restrict the allowed effective response parameter space.

10 Limitations

The main limitations are:

- absence of a complete microscopic derivation;
- reliance on effective phenomenological parameters;
- reduced-order simulations that do not yet replace full-wave modeling;
- preliminary experimental sensitivity above the most stringent target regime;
- absence of independent replication.

These limitations define the next stage of work rather than being hidden weaknesses.

11 Roadmap

Near-term priorities include full-wave electromagnetic modeling, improved vibration isolation, high-vacuum testing, stronger thermal control, orientation-reversal trials, public release of simulation data, and independent replication attempts.

12 Conclusion

EVRT is best understood as a unified, falsifiable research program for investigating possible nonequilibrium electromagnetic stress-asymmetry behavior. Its present contribution is the organization of a speculative idea into a coherent pathway involving theoretical constraints, numerical predictions, experimental protocols, and baseline measurement work.

If future experiments demonstrate a reproducible, control-dependent force pattern consistent with the predicted scaling behavior, this would suggest that boundary-condition-dependent electromagnetic stress distributions may exhibit measurable structure beyond conventional lumped interpretations. Such a result would motivate deeper theoretical investigation into electromagnetic stress-energy behavior in structured, nonequilibrium systems.

Conversely, strong null results at sufficient sensitivity would place meaningful constraints on the phenomenological parameter space and help refine or eliminate candidate models.

The decisive next step is therefore not additional speculation, but improved experimental sensitivity and reproducible control-dependent testing.

References

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